

Build a Team That Helps You Grow

Human Resources

Book 6



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Chapter 1 Legal Compliance & Paperwork

New hires, forms, and basic rules to follow.

When you hire someone, you are no longer “just a business owner.” You are now an employer.

That means there are rules you must follow: forms to fill out, records to keep, laws to respect, basics to get right. This chapter is about doing the minimum correctly so you don't get fined, sued, or stressed later. Not fancy HR. Not corporate nonsense. Just the basics that keep you safe.

- Forms to fill out
- Records to keep
- Laws to respect
- Basics to get right

Why This Matters: Hiring someone without paperwork is one of the fastest ways to get yourself in trouble. Most small business owners say: “It's just one person.” “They're basically a friend.” “I'll figure it out later.” “I'll pay them cash for now.” That mindset leads to: IRS problems, labor complaints, fines, back pay, stress, and legal letters you don't want to open. You don't need to be perfect. You just need to be legal enough.

- “It's just one person.”
- “They're basically a friend.”
- “I'll figure it out later.”
- “I'll pay them cash for now.”
- IRS problems
- Labor complaints
- Fines
- Back pay
- Stress
- Legal letters you don't want to open

A Cleaning Company Hiring Its First Employee

You've been cleaning homes yourself. Work is growing. You're booked out. You're tired. So you hire someone to help. This is the exact moment where most owners mess up — not because they're bad people, but because they don't know the rules. Let's fix that.

The 4 Things You Must Do When Hiring Someone

1. Decide: Employee or Contractor (This Matters)

You must decide before they start. Employee → You control schedule, tasks, how work is done. Contractor → They control how and when they work. Most cleaning helpers are employees, not contractors.

- Set their hours
- Tell them how to clean
- Provide supplies
- Train them

They are an employee. Calling them a contractor doesn't make it true. The IRS decides — not you.

2. Collect Basic New-Hire Forms

- I-9 → Confirms they can legally work
- W-4 → Tells you how much tax to withhold
- State new-hire form (varies by state)

That's it at the beginner level. You don't need a lawyer. You don't need HR software yet. You just need the forms completed and stored.

3. Keep Simple Records

- Name
- Address
- Start date
- Pay rate
- Hours worked

This protects you, not just them. If there's ever a question, you have proof: what they were paid, when they worked, what you agreed to. No records = your word vs theirs. That never ends well.

4. Follow Basic Labor Rules

- Pay at least minimum wage
- Pay on time
- Track hours
- Follow overtime rules (if applicable)
- “Forget” to pay
- Delay paychecks
- Guess hours
- Change pay without notice

Employees don’t quit jobs — they quit bad systems.

What NOT to Do (Cleaning Business Mistakes)

- Pay under the table
- Skip forms
- Call everyone a contractor
- Say “we’ll figure it out later”
- Ignore state rules
- Pay randomly
- Keep everything in your head

These mistakes don’t feel dangerous — until they are.

Let's Put It All Together (Cleaning Example)

1. Decide they are an employee
2. Have them complete I-9 and W-4
3. Record start date and hourly rate
4. Track hours worked
5. Pay them on a consistent schedule

Now: you're legal, you're protected, you're calm, you're building a real business. Not perfect. Just solid and safe.

One-Sentence Summary

Hiring someone makes you an employer — paperwork keeps you protected.

Chapter 1 Summary

Quick Recap

- Hiring creates legal responsibility
- Decide employee vs contractor correctly
- Collect basic forms
- Track hours and pay
- Follow minimum wage and pay rules
- Simple systems prevent big problems

You don't need to be fancy. You just need to be clean, clear, and compliant.

Chapter 2

Payroll Setup & Pay Schedule

Paying people correctly and on time.



What This Means: Payroll is how you pay your people. Not just how much you pay, but when you pay, how you pay, and how consistently you pay. Payroll is not optional. It's not flexible. It's not something you "figure out later." When you hire someone, payroll becomes a promise. Break that promise — and trust is gone.

Why This Matters

Nothing kills a team faster than late or confusing pay.

You can be a great boss, be nice, be flexible, be understanding. But if pay is late, wrong, or unpredictable — none of that matters. People don't work for vibes. They work for money.

- Stress
- Anger
- Distrust
- Turnover
- Legal risk
- Stability
- Trust
- Professionalism
- Retention

Payroll isn't about money. It's about reliability.

This Chapter's Example: A Landscaping Business With 3 Employees

The owner runs jobs during the week: mowing, trimming, cleanup. Employees depend on gas money, rent money, grocery money. If payroll is late, their lives get disrupted fast. This makes landscaping a perfect example of why payroll must be boring and predictable.

The 4 Parts of a Simple Payroll System

1. Choose How Often You Pay

Pick one schedule and stick to it. Most small businesses choose weekly (simple, fast, popular), bi-weekly (every two weeks), or twice a month (15th & 30th). Beginner rule: Weekly or bi-weekly is easiest. Don't change it every month. Consistency builds trust.

2. Choose How You Pay

- Direct deposit
- Payroll app (Gusto, ADP, QuickBooks Payroll, etc.)
- Paper check (last resort)
- Cash
- Zelle
- Venmo
- "I'll send it later"

Those create confusion and risk. A payroll tool costs money — but it saves time, stress, and mistakes.

3. Track Hours the Same Way Every Time

- Who worked
- How long
- On which days
- Time clock app
- Spreadsheet
- Written timesheet signed weekly

Bad payroll always starts with bad time tracking. No hours = no payroll. No payroll = angry employees.

4. Pay On Time — Every Time

Pick a payday and never miss it. Example: “We pay every Friday for hours worked Monday–Friday.” If payday is Friday: payroll must run Thursday; hours must be submitted Wednesday. Late pay = broken trust. One late paycheck does more damage than ten “good job” speeches.

What Payroll Looks Like (Landscaping Example)

- Pay schedule: Every Friday
- Pay method: Direct deposit
- Time tracking: Weekly timesheet
- Payroll tool: Simple payroll app

Now every employee knows when they get paid, how much to expect, how hours are counted, and that the business is stable. That stability makes people stay.

What NOT to Do

- “I’ll pay you when the client pays me”
- Paying whenever cash is available
- Changing paydays
- Guessing hours
- Paying late and apologizing
- Mixing payroll with personal money

Apologies don’t fix payroll problems. Systems do.

Let’s Put It All Together (Landscaping Example)

Before: Owner pays randomly; employees ask “when do we get paid?”; trust is shaky; turnover is high. After: Payroll runs weekly; pay hits on time; employees stop worrying; owner stops stressing; business feels professional. Same work. Different system. Better outcome.

One-Sentence Summary

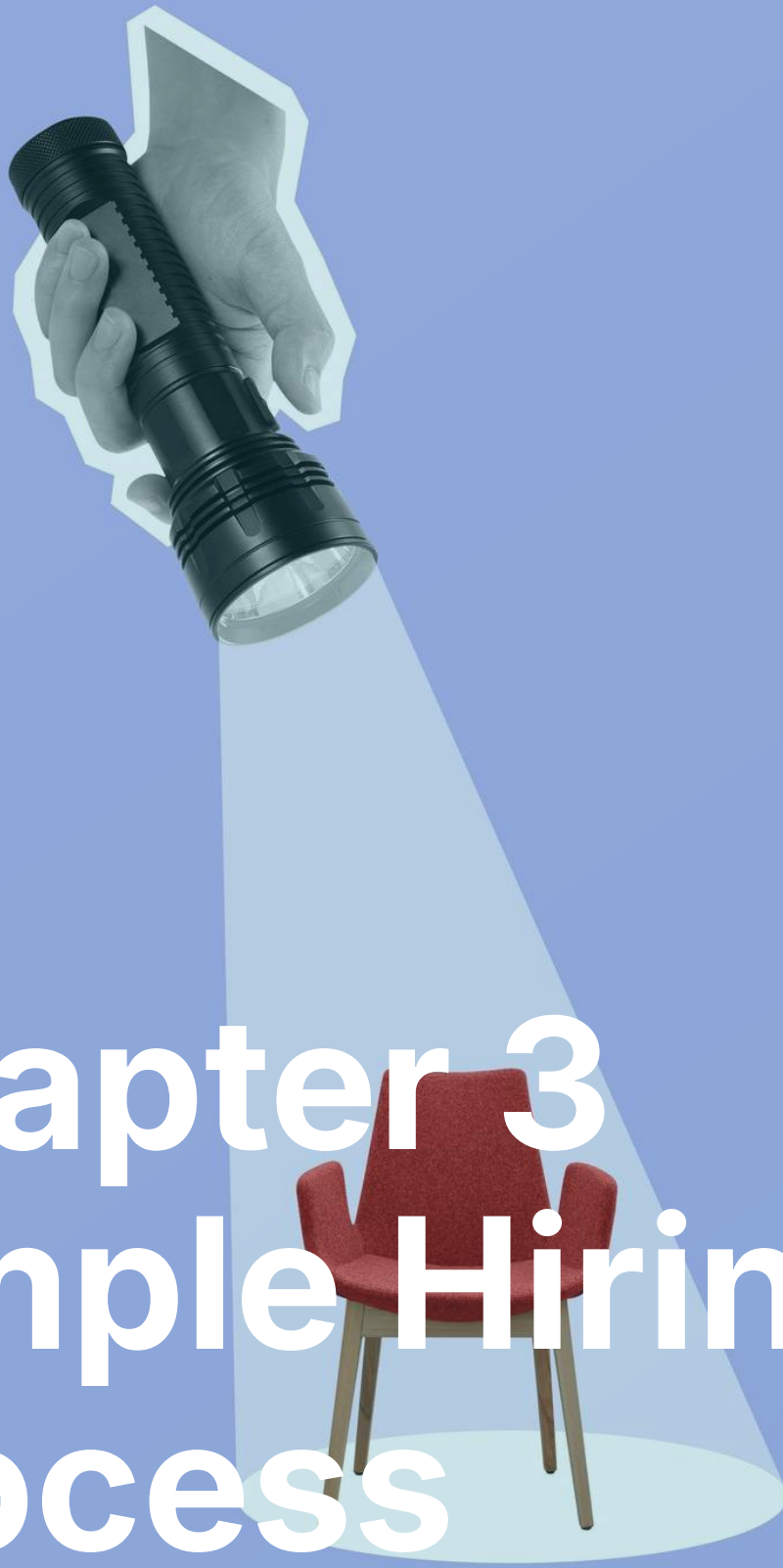
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If payroll isn’t boring and predictable, your team won’t last.

Quick Recap

- Payroll is a promise
- Pick one pay schedule and stick to it
- Use a payroll tool — not cash
- Track hours consistently
- Pay on time, every time
- Reliability builds trust

A business that pays right keeps good people.



Chapter 3

Simple Hiring

Process

Screening, interviewing, and choosing the right fit.

What This Means: Hiring is not about finding someone with the perfect resume. It's about finding someone who will show up, do the work, follow directions, and treat customers well. Most small business owners overthink hiring — or worse, rush it. This chapter is about building a simple, repeatable hiring process so you stop guessing and stop hiring the wrong people.

Why This Matters

Bad hires cost you more than slow growth. A bad hire leads to missed shifts, poor work quality, angry customers, extra supervision, re-training, stress, and letting someone go (which is never fun). One bad hire can kill your confidence, burn your time, and damage your reputation.

Hiring slow and right is always faster than hiring fast and wrong.

This Chapter's Example: A Local Coffee Shop Hiring a Barista

The shop is busy in the mornings. Customers want speed, friendliness, and consistency. The owner needs someone who can show up early, follow a process, handle pressure, be polite, and learn quickly. This is a perfect example of how simple hiring beats fancy hiring.

The 3-Step Simple Hiring Process

Step 1: Screen for Reliability First

Before skills. Before experience. Before personality. You are screening for: Can they follow instructions? Can they communicate clearly? Can they show up on time? Example screen question: "We start at 6:30 AM. Can you commit to that schedule every weekday?" If they hesitate — you have your answer. Reliability beats talent every time.

Step 2: Interview for Attitude, Not Resume

- Tell me about a time you were under pressure.
- What do you do when you make a mistake?
- What does good customer service mean to you?

You're listening for ownership, honesty, calm thinking, and respect. You are NOT listening for fancy words.

Step 3: Be Clear About Expectations

- Pay rate
- Schedule
- Duties
- Rules
- What "doing a good job" looks like

Example for barista: "We expect you to arrive 10 minutes early, follow the drink process exactly, and treat every customer kindly — even when it's busy." Clarity now prevents conflict later.

What NOT to Do

- Hire out of desperation
- Skip interviews
- Assume "they'll figure it out"
- Ignore red flags
- Hire friends without standards
- Overvalue experience
- Under-communicate expectations

A rushed hire is usually a regret.

Let's Put It All Together (Coffee Shop Example)

1. Screens for availability and reliability
2. Interviews for attitude and calmness
3. Clearly explains expectations

They hire someone who shows up, learns quickly, treats customers well, and fits the role. Less stress. Better service. Stronger team.

One-Sentence Summary

Hire for reliability and attitude — skills can be taught.

Quick Recap

- Hiring doesn't need to be complicated
- Screen for reliability first
- Interview for attitude, not resumes
- Be clear about expectations
- Slow hiring beats fast regret
- Simple systems create better teams

Good teams aren't found by luck. They're built on clarity.

Chapter 4

New

Employee

Onboarding

How to get new team members started strong.



What This Means: Onboarding is what happens after you hire someone but before they work on their own. It's how you set expectations, show them how things work, teach standards, prevent confusion, and build confidence.

**Onboarding is not paperwork.
Onboarding is not “shadow me for a day.” Onboarding is how you turn a hire into a contributor.**

Why This Matters

Most employees don't fail — they are failed by bad onboarding. Bad onboarding looks like: “Just watch and you'll get it.” “Ask questions if you need help.” “This is how we usually do it.” “You'll figure it out.” That creates anxiety, mistakes, frustration, inconsistent work, and early quitting.

When people don't know what “good” looks like, they guess. And guessing creates problems. Good onboarding removes guesswork.

This Chapter's Example: A Residential Moving Company Hiring a Mover
The company helps people move homes. Jobs are physical, fast, and stressful. New movers must lift safely, communicate clearly, respect customers' homes, follow a system, and work as a team. Bad onboarding here causes broken items, injuries, angry customers, and high turnover. Good onboarding makes everything smoother.

The 4 Parts of Strong Onboarding

1. Day-One Expectations

- Start time
- Dress code
- Breaks
- Pay schedule
- Who they report to
- What success looks like

Example: "You arrive at 7:45 AM, wear company shirt, follow the move leader's instructions, and treat every item like it's fragile." Clarity creates confidence.

2. Show the Standard — Don't Just Explain It

- How to lift a couch
- How to wrap furniture
- How to load the truck
- How to speak to customers

Don't say: "Be careful." Show how to do it the right way. People copy what they see.

3. Walk Through a Full Job

- How the day starts
- How the truck is loaded
- How problems are handled
- How the job ends
- How customers are spoken to

This helps them understand: "This is how everything fits together." Context reduces mistakes.

4. Give Simple Rules to Follow

- Ask before moving valuables
- Never rush inside a customer's home
- Speak respectfully at all times
- Report damage immediately
- Follow the move leader

Rules are not controlling. They are guardrails. Guardrails keep people safe.

What NOT to Do

- Throw them into work immediately
- Assume past experience = knowledge
- Overload them with information
- Skip expectations
- Change rules mid-day
- Let bad habits form early

Fixing bad habits later is harder than teaching good ones early.

Let's Put It All Together (Moving Company Example)

Day 1: Explains expectations, shows lifting and wrapping, walks through a full job, gives simple rules. Now the new mover knows what to do, knows what "good" looks like, feels confident, makes fewer mistakes, stays longer. Good onboarding saves time every single day after.

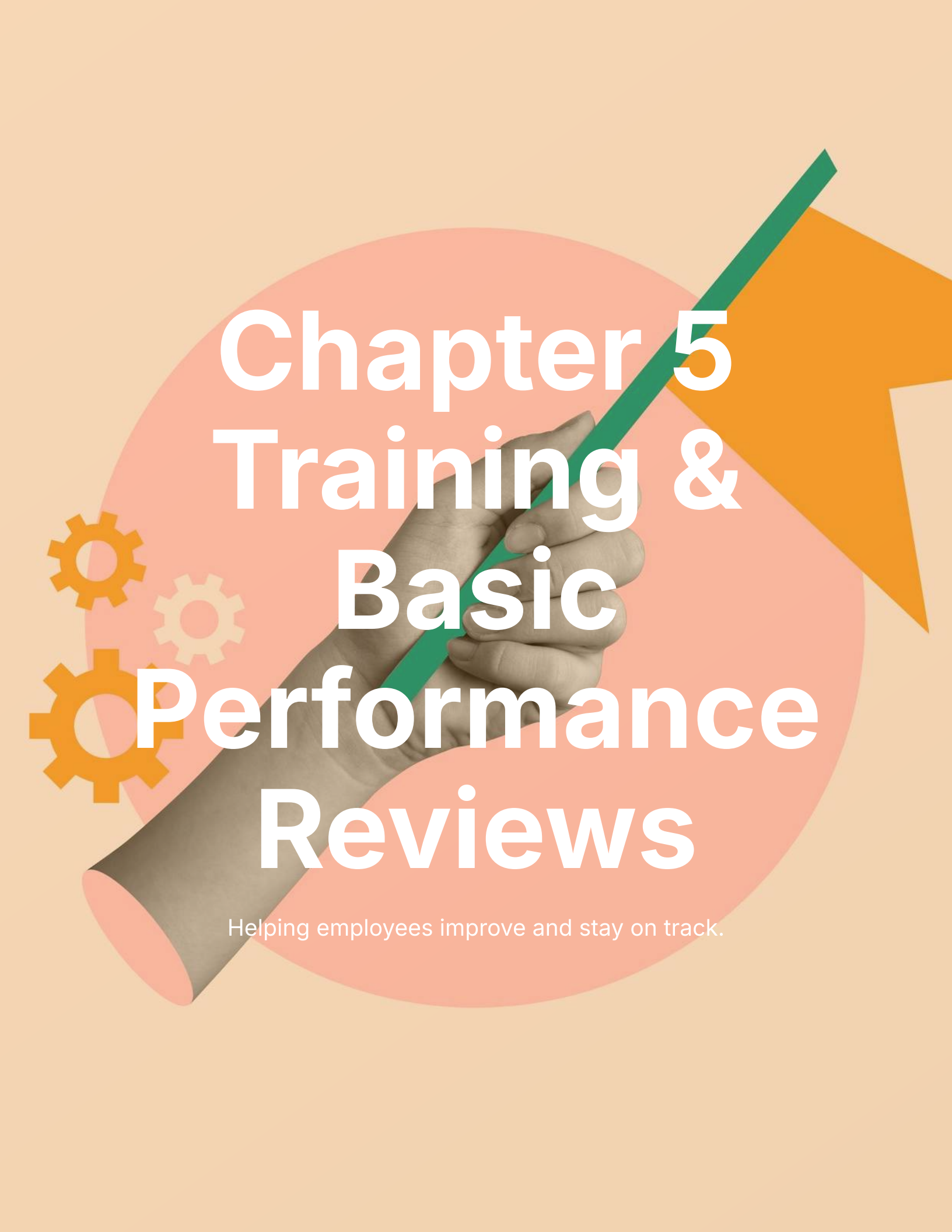
One-Sentence Summary

Onboarding is how you replace confusion with confidence.

Quick Recap

- Onboarding starts after hiring
- Set expectations early
- Show standards — don't just explain
- Walk through a full job
- Give clear rules
- Strong onboarding prevents mistakes and turnover

You don't need perfect employees. You need clear starts.



Chapter 5 Training & Basic Performance Reviews

Helping employees improve and stay on track.

Training is how employees learn to do the job the right way. Performance reviews are how you make sure they keep doing it that way.

This is not corporate HR. This is not annual paperwork. This is simply: teaching clearly, checking in regularly, fixing small issues early, and helping good people get better. If you don't train and review, employees don't magically improve. They repeat habits — good or bad.

Why This Matters

Most employee problems are not attitude problems — they are clarity problems. Owners say: "They should know this by now." "I already told them once." "Why do they keep doing it wrong?" But employees think: "I didn't know that mattered." "No one said it was wrong." "I thought this was fine." Without training and feedback, small mistakes become big ones, good employees get frustrated, bad habits get locked in, owners get resentful, and turnover increases. Training and reviews keep everyone aligned.

This Chapter's Example: A Front-Desk Employee at a Gym

The front desk is the first impression: greeting members, checking people in, answering questions, handling complaints, taking payments. If this role is sloppy, the whole gym feels unprofessional. This makes it a perfect example for training and performance reviews.

Part 1: Simple Training That Works

Training does not mean dumping information. It means teaching what matters most first.

Train the "Big 3" First

1. How to greet members
2. How to check people in correctly
3. How to handle basic questions or issues

If they get these three things right, 80% of the job is done well. Don't overwhelm them. Build confidence first.

Show → Watch → Do

1. You show it
2. They watch
3. They do it
4. You correct gently

Example: You greet members properly; they watch; they greet the next person; you give feedback right away. This locks learning in fast.

Train in Small Pieces

Don't teach everything in one day. Teach one task, one standard, one expectation. Then repeat tomorrow. Repetition beats information.

Part 2: Basic Performance Reviews (Beginner Level)

A performance review does not need to be formal or scary. It should be short, calm, honest, helpful, and consistent.

The Simple Review Formula

1. "What you're doing well "
2. "What needs improvement "
3. "What success looks like going forward "

Example for gym front desk: "You're great at greeting members and staying positive. One thing to improve is checking people in faster during busy hours. Going forward, let's aim to keep the line moving smoothly between 5–7 PM." That's it. Clear. Respectful. Actionable.

How Often to Review

- Quick check-ins weekly (5 minutes)
- Slightly longer review monthly

Do not wait: 6 months, a year, or until you're frustrated.

Small feedback early prevents big conversations later.

What NOT to Do

- Only give feedback when angry
- Save problems for "later"
- Be vague ("Just do better")
- Avoid uncomfortable conversations
- Expect improvement without guidance
- Assume silence means approval

Let's Put It All Together (Gym Example)

The gym owner trains the front desk employee on greetings, check-ins, and questions; watches performance during busy hours; gives quick weekly feedback; does monthly check-ins; corrects issues early. Now the employee knows what "good" looks like, improves steadily, feels supported, stays longer, and performs better. The owner spends less time fixing mistakes, feels calmer, and builds a stronger team. Training and reviews don't slow growth. They enable it.

One-Sentence Summary

Training teaches the standard — reviews keep it in place.

Quick Recap

- Training builds skills and confidence
- Focus on the most important tasks first
- Show → watch → do → correct
- Give feedback early and often
- Reviews should be short and clear
- Clarity keeps good employees growing

You don't need perfect people. You need clear guidance and steady feedback.

Simple Interpretation for Small Business Owners

Books 1–3 teach you how to *get customers*.

Books 4–5 teach you how to *keep customers*.

Books 6–8 teach you how to *run the business behind the scenes*.

Book 9 teaches you how to *lead the business like a CEO*.

PHASE 1 — FOUNDATIONS

What you sell, who you sell it to, and how people find you.

1. PRODUCT (Start Here)

Build something people want → understand problem, customer, offer, landscape, MVP.

Unlocks: Marketing + Sales effectiveness.

2. MARKETING

Now that you know your offer and customer → learn to generate leads.

Unlocks: Sales pipeline consistency.

3. SALES

Once leads are coming in → learn to convert them into revenue.

Unlocks: Customer Success workflows and financial predictability.

Why this phase matters:

You go from *"I have an idea"* → *"I can attract and close paying customers."*

PHASE 2 — DELIVERY SYSTEMS

How you turn customers into raving fans and repeat buyers.

4. CUSTOMER SUCCESS

Once sales convert customers → you learn to onboard, deliver, and retain.

Unlocks: Recurring revenue + testimonials + operational clarity.

5. OPERATIONS

Now you systematize the entire delivery engine: SOPs, checklists, templates, processes.

Unlocks: Quality control, scalability, and reduced chaos.

Why this phase matters:

You go from *"I can sell"* → *"I can consistently deliver and retain."*

PHASE 3 — BUSINESS INFRASTRUCTURE

Tools, numbers, and people who make the machine run.

6. TECHNOLOGY

Once operations are forming → you add the tools that support scale (CRM, website, email, payments).

Unlocks: Data visibility, automation, and speed.

7. HUMAN RESOURCES

Once delivery is predictable → you hire and train people to help.

Unlocks: Delegation, team growth, and freeing the founder.

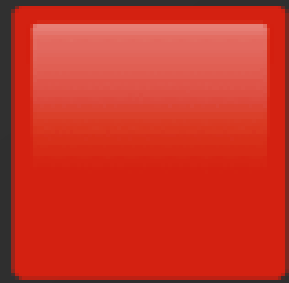
8. FINANCE

Once business grows → you install financial basics (bank accounts, bookkeeping, cash flow, budget, taxes).

Unlocks: Correct pricing, healthy margins, and sustainable growth.

Why this phase matters:

You go from *"I do everything manually"* → *"My business has real systems and support."*



PHASE

4 —

SCALING

THE

BUSINESS

You become the CEO instead of the operator.

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